

Curriculum Vitae

Stephanie Y. Chia

College Park, Maryland | sychia@umd.edu | <https://stephchia.github.io>

Education

Expected 2026 **Ph.D. Candidate in Ecology and Evolution**, University of Maryland (UMD)
2017 **M.S. Sustainable Business and Innovation**, Utrecht University, Netherlands
2015 **B.S. Life Science**, National Taiwan University, Taiwan
Study abroad, University of British Columbia, Canada (2013)

Fellowships

2024-2026 Taiwan Ministry of Education Study Abroad Scholarship (\$32,000)
2024 Smithsonian National Zoo and Conservation Biology Institute Fellowship (\$3,750)
2022 National Science Foundation Global STEWARDS Fellowship at UMD
2021-2022 University of Maryland Dean's Fellowship (\$5,000)

Research and professional experience

2021- **Doctoral research, University of Maryland, USA**
Advisor: [Bill Fagan](#)
Projects: bird nest macroecology, bird morphology macroevolution, cropland optimization for water saving

2019-2021 **Research Assistant, Biodiversity Research Center, Academia Sinica, Taiwan**
Advisor: [Mao-Ning Tuanmu](#)
Projects: moth community ecology, bird macroecology on altitudinal migration

2017-2019 **Assistant Engineer, SGS Ltd., Taiwan**
[Climate Change Innovative Actions Team](#)
Projects: climate change risk assessment, flood prediction and response, urban cooling

2015-2017 **Master's research, Utrecht University, Netherlands**
Advisor: [Agni Kalfagianni](#)
Thesis: Reducing food waste through waste monitoring and consumption forecast

2014 **Undergrad research, National Taiwan University, Taiwan**
Project: Climate-adaptive strategies of organic tea farming
Project: Real-time analysis of per-second groundwater level records

Publications

Peer-reviewed journals

Fagan WF, Krishnan AG, Fleming CH, Sharkey E, [Chia SY](#), Swain A, ... 150+ authors. (2025). Wild canids and felids differ in their reliance on travel routes with implications for encounter dynamics. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 122 (40) e2401042122.

[Chia SY](#), Wu S, Lu Y-J, Jang Y-S, Huang C-C, Shen S-F, Chen I-C, Tuanmu M-N. (2024). Mechanistic understanding of how temperature and its variability shape body size composition in moth communities. *Functional Ecology*, 38(1), 206-218. (shortlisted for Haldane Prize)

[Chia SY](#), Fang Y-T, Su Y-T, Tsai P-Y, Hsieh C, Tsao S-H, Juang J-Y, Hung C-M, Tuanmu M-N. (2023). A global dataset of bird nest traits. *Scientific Data*, 10, 923.

Tsai P-Y, Ko C-J, [Chia SY](#), Lu Y-J, Tuanmu M-N. (2021). New insights into the patterns and drivers of avian altitudinal migration from a growing crowdsourcing data source. *Ecography*, 44(1), 75-86.

Upcoming

[Chia SY](#), Tsai-Chen Y, Tuanmu M-N, Fagan WF. Predation, climate, and life-history traits shape macroecological patterns of enclosed bird nests. *Preprint* (in review).

[Chia SY](#), Swain A, Josephs N, Lin L, Fagan WF. Birds that don't exist: niche pre-emption as a constraint on morphological evolution in the Passeroidea. *Preprint* (in review).

Presentations

Talks

2025 Ecological Society of America, Baltimore, MD, USA.

2024 Mathematical Biology Seminar, Department of Mathematics, UMD.

2023 American Society of Agronomy, Crop Science Society of America and Soil Science Society of America, St. Louis, MO, USA.

2023 American Ornithological Society and Society of Canadian Ornithologists, London, ON, Canada.

2022 Belmont Forum Climate Environment and Health Early Career Researcher Workshop, virtual.

2021 Congress of Animal Behavior and Ecology, Taiwan, virtual.

Posters

2024 American Ornithological Society, Estes Park, CO, USA.

2021 Ecological Society of America, virtual.

2020 British Ecological Society, virtual.

Teaching experience

HNUH 258C Nature at Risk: Extinction, Consequences, and Strategies, UMD

Teaching assistant (Fall 2025)

Course material development (from Fall 2024 to Summer 2025)

BSCI 462 / BIOL 708R Population Ecology, UMD

Guest lecturer (Spring 2025)

Teaching assistant (Spring 2024), funded by UMD Teaching and Learning Grant to integrate global change into undergrad biology curriculum

BSCI 201 Human Anatomy and Physiology, UMD

Teaching assistant (Spring 2022, Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Fall 2023)

Awards and grants

2024	UMD Behavior, Ecology, Evolution, and Systematics Best Graduate Research Talk
2024	Jacob K. Goldhaber Travel Grant, UMD (\$400)
2024	Biological Sciences Graduate Program Travel Award, UMD (\$500)
2024	Department of Biology Travel Award, UMD (\$750)
2023	UMD Outstanding Graduate Teaching Assistant Award
2023	Global STEWARDS Travel Grant, UMD (\$1,500)
2023	Jacob K. Goldhaber Travel Grant, UMD (\$600)
2023	International Conference Student Support Award, UMD (\$500)
2023	American Ornithological Society Travel Award (\$560)
2021	Ecological Society of America Registration Grant

Service and outreach

2022-2025	Multiple graduate student committees, BEES program, UMD
2022	Seminar committee, Global STEWARDS program, UMD
2019-2020	Public educational materials development for open house events, Academia Sinica
2018	Social housing resource integration platform policy proposal, Taiwan
2017	Polylactic acid (PLA) cups recycling initiative, Netherlands
2015	Nuclear waste management legislation team, Taiwan

Skills

Programming languages and software

R, Python, HTML & CSS, Git, QGIS, Gurobi

Ecological and computational skills

High-performance computing, Topological data analysis, Linear programming, Phylogenetic comparative methods, Ancestral state reconstruction, Network analysis, Species distribution modeling, Spatial data analysis, Biodiversity measurement, Animal tracking data analysis

Languages Mandarin Chinese, English

Others WMA wilderness first responder, PADI advanced open water diver, NCMW adult mental health first aid certification